

Minimum Standards Compliance Checklist

New York's Minimum Standards for Public and Association Libraries (8 NYCRR § 90.2) set 14 baseline requirements every member library must meet to stay registered and eligible for LLSA and LSSA aid. Trustees, not just the director, are legally responsible for ensuring the library meets them. Use this checklist to confirm compliance and complete this year's required actions.

The 14 Minimum Standards

- ☐ **1. Written bylaws** of the Board of Trustees are adopted and current. (*review at least every 5 years*)
- ☐ **2. Long-range plan of service** is community-based, written, and board-approved.
- ☐ **3. Annual report to the community** on progress toward the library's mission, goals, and objectives is board-approved. (*annual*)
- ☐ **4. Written operating policies** covering required areas are adopted and current. (*review at least every 5 years*)
- ☐ **5. Annual budget** is board-approved and addresses community needs identified in the long-range plan. (*annual*)
- ☐ **6. Periodic evaluation** of the effectiveness of programs, services, and collections is conducted.
- ☐ **7. Minimum weekly hours of service** are met for the library's population served (see table below).
- ☐ **8. Adequate facility** provides sufficient space, lighting, shelving, power/data infrastructure, and a public restroom.
- ☐ **9. Programming** addresses needs identified in the community.
- ☐ **10. Circulation system** provides access to the local collection and other library catalogs, plus needed equipment, technology, and internet connectivity.
- ☐ **11. Public access to current library information** items 1–5 above must be made available on the library's website and in print.
- ☐ **12. Paid director** meets the minimum education qualification for the library's chartered population (see table below).
- ☐ **13. Annual technology training** appropriate to position is provided for staff. (*annual*)
- ☐ **14. Established partnerships** with educational, cultural, or community organizations address identified community needs.

Standard 7 — Minimum Weekly Hours by Population Served

Population Served	Minimum Weekly Hours
Up to 500	12
500 – 2,499	20
2,500 – 4,999	25
5,000 – 14,999	35
15,000 – 24,999	40
25,000 – 99,999	55
100,000+	60

Standard 12 — Director Education by Chartered Population

Chartered Population	Minimum Education Requirement
2,500 – 4,999	Two years of college study
5,000 – 7,499	Bachelor's degree
7,500+	MLS + NYS Public Librarian's Professional Certificate

Note: recheck both tables against current Decennial Census figures — population shifts can move a library between hours or education tiers.

Required Actions for This Board

☐ **Pass the annual Minimum Standards compliance motion.**

Use this language, or something close to it:

[TRUSTEE NAME] moves that the [Library Name] Board of Trustees affirms that the library is in full compliance with the New York State Minimum Standards for Public and Association Libraries, as outlined in Commissioner's Regulation § 90.2, and directs [NAME] to email the OWWL Library System Executive Director a link to the board meeting minutes once posted to the library's website, within two weeks of the meeting, in accordance with New York State Open Meetings Law. [TRUSTEE NAME] seconds, and the motion passed unanimously.

A motion that does not capture the actual action taken will not satisfy this requirement.

☐ **Send the meeting minutes link to OWWL.** Once the motion passes and minutes are posted to the library's website, email the OWWL Library System Executive Director the link. Due: **within 2 weeks of the board meeting.**